

Information Security Policy

1. Purpose

This policy protects Meridian's information and systems.

2. Passwords and sign-in

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, VPN and all cloud applications. Passwords must never be shared, including with IT staff.

3. Data classification

Data is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Restricted. Customer personal data and payment data are Restricted.

4. Handling restricted data

Restricted data must not be stored on personal devices, personal cloud storage or USB drives. Restricted data must not be pasted into public AI tools. Only company-approved AI tools listed on the IT portal may be used with Internal or Confidential data.

5. Incident reporting

Suspected security incidents, including lost laptops and phishing emails, must be reported to security@meridian.example within 1 hour of discovery.

6. Device security

Company laptops lock automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity. Disk encryption and endpoint protection must stay enabled.

7. Access reviews

Managers review their team's system access every quarter. Access for leavers is removed on their last working day.

8. Training

All employees complete security awareness training when they join and every 12 months after that.